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Travel and Expense

This policy explains which business costs Acme Corp reimburses, the limits that apply, how to claim, and who approves claims. It applies to all employees who incur costs on behalf of Acme Corp, including business travel, client entertainment, training and home-office setup.

Policy owner: Finance team.

Principles

Spend company money as carefully as you would spend your own. Every expense must be necessary for business, reasonable in amount, supported by evidence, and approved by the right person. Personal costs are never reimbursed, even if they arise during a business trip.

Where this policy does not cover a situation, ask your manager or the Finance team before you spend, not afterwards.

Planning Business Travel

Business travel must be approved by your manager before any booking is made. Use the Acme Corp travel booking tool for flights, rail and hotels wherever possible, because it applies negotiated rates and records your trip for duty-of-care purposes.

Consider whether a video call could achieve the same result before planning a trip.

Booking Lead Time

Book flights at least 14 days before departure where possible. Bookings made fewer than 7 days before departure must include a short explanation in the travel request.

Air Travel

- Flights with a scheduled flight time under 6 hours must be booked in economy class.
- Flights with a scheduled flight time of 6 hours or more may be booked in premium economy.
- Business class requires prior written approval from the CFO and is reserved for exceptional medical or security needs.

Choose the lowest reasonable fare that fits your schedule. Fees for seat selection are reimbursed only for flights over 4 hours. One checked bag is reimbursed per trip of 3 nights or more.

Loyalty points earned on business travel may be kept by the employee, but must never influence the choice of airline or hotel.

Rail and Ground Transport

Standard-class rail is the default. First-class rail is allowed for journeys of more than 3 hours when booked at least 7 days in advance and the fare is no more than 25% above standard class.

Taxis and ride-hailing are reimbursed when public transport is impractical, unsafe, or late at night (after 21:00). Car rental requires manager approval and should be the smallest suitable vehicle.

Mileage

Employees who use their own car for business journeys are reimbursed at \$0.60 per mile. Commuting between home and your normal office is not business mileage. Record the start point, destination, purpose and distance for every journey.

Accommodation

Hotel costs are reimbursed up to \$200 per night, excluding taxes. In high-cost cities listed on the Finance intranet page, the limit is \$300 per night. Stays above the limit require manager approval before booking.

Book standard rooms. Personal extras such as minibar items, films, spa services and laundry for trips shorter than 5 nights are not reimbursed.

Meals and Per Diem

Meals during business travel are covered by a daily per diem allowance rather than individual receipts:

- Domestic travel: \$75 per day.
- International travel: \$110 per day.

On the first and last day of a trip, the per diem is 75% of the daily rate. If a meal is provided (for example, by a conference or a client), reduce the per diem by 20% for breakfast, 30% for lunch and 50% for dinner.

Per diem is claimed in the expense system and does not need receipts. It covers meals, snacks, non-alcoholic drinks and tips.

Client Entertainment

Client entertainment, including meals with customers or partners, is claimed with itemised receipts, the names of attendees and the business purpose. The limit is \$100 per person per event,

including tax and tip. Events above the limit require department head approval in advance.

Alcohol

Alcohol is not reimbursable, except as part of approved client entertainment and in reasonable quantities.

Other Reimbursable Expenses

- Visa and passport fees for business travel.
- Mobile roaming charges for business calls during travel, if the company plan does not already cover them.
- Training and conference fees, when approved under the learning budget in the Benefits and Wellness policy (POL-12).
- Home-office setup costs under the stipend in the Remote and Hybrid Work policy (POL-05).

Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following are never reimbursed: fines and penalties (including parking and speeding fines), personal travel insurance, upgrades not covered by this policy, personal entertainment, gifts to colleagues, and costs for family members or guests who travel with you.

Receipts

An itemised receipt is required for every individual expense over \$25. Credit card statements alone are not acceptable as receipts. For expenses of \$25 or less, a receipt is recommended but not required, provided the expense is described clearly.

If a receipt is lost, complete a missing-receipt declaration in the expense system. Missing-receipt declarations are allowed at most 3 times per calendar year.

Submitting Claims

Submit expense claims through the expense system within 30 days of the date the expense was incurred. Claims submitted more than 90 days after the expense will not be reimbursed.

Each claim must include the date, amount, currency, category, business purpose and receipt (where required). Foreign currency expenses are converted at the rate on the date of the transaction.

Approved claims are paid with the next monthly salary payment if approved by the 15th of the month.

Approval Chain

Every claim must be approved before it is paid. The approval level depends on the total amount of the claim:

- Up to \$1,000: approval by the employee's manager.
- Over \$1,000 and up to \$5,000: approval by the manager and then the department head.
- Over \$5,000: approval by the manager, the department head and then the Chief Financial Officer (CFO).

No one may approve their own expenses or the expenses of their own manager. Claims from department heads are approved by the CFO; claims from the CFO are approved by the CEO.

Corporate Cards

Employees who travel more than 6 times a year may apply for a corporate card. Corporate cards may only be used for business expenses. Transactions must be reconciled in the expense system within 30 days, with receipts attached, using the same rules as personal claims. Cash withdrawals on a corporate card are not allowed.

Misuse

Submitting false or inflated claims is treated as gross misconduct under the Code of Conduct and Anti-Harassment policy (POL-10). The Finance team audits a random sample of claims every month.

Document Control

Version 1.0, effective 1 January 2026, owner Finance team. First release.